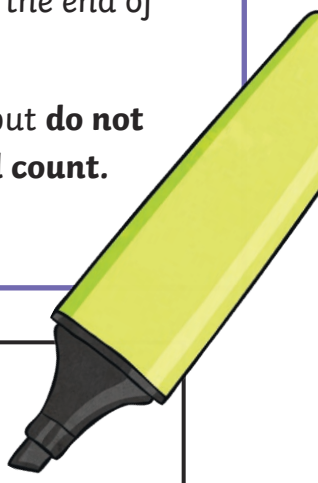
Summary Writing Practice

English Home Language | Grade 8

Read the passage below and write a summary of between 60-70 words.

Instructions

- Mention **SEVEN** disadvantages of the internet in a fluent **paragraph** of no more than 70 words.
- Use full sentences.
- Use your **OWN** words.
- Indicate your word count at the end of your summary.
- Give your summary a title, but **do not include the title in the word count.**



Internet use for extended periods of time tends to isolate people from their friends and family. Many people meet friends and partners online, but cyber relationships are no substitute for socialising in real life. In fact, it is possible for internet users to become addicted. Although this kind of addiction differs from chemical addiction, it is a rising problem. Some people lose their jobs and suffer other negative effects from overuse.

There are many authentic websites on the net that offer factual, valid information, however, there is also an abundance of sites overflowing with false information. Unfortunately, many internet users find it difficult to differentiate between them.

When people use their personal information online when shopping or banking, it creates an opportunity for hackers to gain access to private data that can be used to steal money and even their identity. Frequent use of the internet often means your computer is exposed to viruses that can crash your system. This can result in you losing important files, personal information, and sometimes even destroying your operating system.

Internet users also run the risk of their children stumbling on or seeking out inappropriate websites when using the internet at home. This can be especially dangerous if the child accidentally shares personal information like an address, telephone number or account numbers. Another problem with excessive internet use is that it has allowed a large number of people to remain anonymous – people who may access various websites, social networks, chat rooms and forums available. This can result in perverted individuals or scammers gaining the trust of innocent people and taking advantage of them.

(adapted from eHow.com)

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Summary Writing Practice **Answers**

The following points should be included in paragraph form:

Disadvantages of Internet Use

1. The internet can isolate you.
2. Users can become "addicted" to the internet.
3. The internet can provide inaccurate information.
4. Hackers can gain access to your private data.
5. Computers can get system-crashing viruses.
6. Children can access inappropriate websites.
7. Due to anonymity, perverts can take advantage of innocent people.

46 words